

PARTNER GUIDE

# Joining the IMWIRSA Global Maritime Welfare Network

A practical guide for seafarers' centres, missions and welfare organisations  
considering partnership with IMWIRSA.

## WHO WE ARE

# About IMWIRSA

IMWIRSA — the International Maritime Welfare Innovation Research and Support Association — is an independent, non-profit international initiative headquartered in Tallinn, Estonia. We bring together researchers, seafarers' centres, maritime unions, port authorities and technology partners around a single goal: making seafarer welfare visible, evidence-based and accessible everywhere a ship calls.

We don't replace the seafarers' centres, missions and chaplaincies that have supported sailors for generations — we connect them. Every partner keeps its name, its funding and its independence; IMWIRSA provides the shared digital layer, research and coordination that lets the whole network work as one.

### Research-led

Grounded in peer-reviewed evidence and real seafarer data.

### Partnership-based

We grow through voluntary partnership, not replacement.

### Technology-enabled

MWApp turns good intentions into something usable.

## THE MODEL

# Four Components of the Platform

1

### Living Port Card

Structured, always-current information about the port: transport, seafarers' centre, shops, medical, safety — maintained by a local MWApp Port Coordinator.

2

### MWApp Port Coordinator

A real person from your centre. New ports are registered through a structured questionnaire; afterwards the coordinator keeps the port card current through a simple Telegram bot, with every change checked by the IMWIRSA team before it goes live.

3

### Volunteer Support Line

A live, anonymous chat available 24/7 for seafarers who need to talk to someone — from directions to a crisis.

4

### Wellness Recovery Zone

A partnership with local specialists — massage, physiotherapy, counselling — offering a short, judgement-free window of relief near the centre.

## WHAT CHANGES FOR YOUR ORGANISATION

# What You Keep, What You Gain

Partnership with IMWIRSA is additive. Your centre's identity, governance and funding remain entirely your own.

### YOU KEEP

- ✓ Full independence
- ✓ Your name, history and identity
- ✓ Your own management and funding
- ✓ Full organisational independence
- ✓ Freedom to work with other networks
- ✓ Right to leave the partnership any time

### YOU GAIN

- ✓ A global network
- ✓ International visibility to seafarers in their own language
- ✓ More visitors through better accessibility
- ✓ Best-practice exchange across the network
- ✓ Free MWApp management tools and analytics
- ✓ Support to establish a Wellness Recovery Zone

### Recognition for Your MWApp Port Coordinator

IMWIRSA offers a flexible recognition model that your organisation and your coordinator choose together:

- **Status & recognition** — official certificate, a named page on the platform, reference letter, private coordinator community access.
- **Financial support** — where budget allows, a monthly stipend (€50–150) and covered connectivity costs.
- **Organisational growth** — free promotion, access to grant programmes, staff training, priority feature access.

## NO SURPRISES

## Conditions of Joining the Pilot

### NOT REQUIRED

- × No hidden costs
- × No mandatory financial contribution
- × No restructuring your organisation
- × No change to your charter or governance
- × No exclusivity — keep working with other networks
- × No new software or hardware to buy

### WHAT'S NEEDED

- ✓ Just one committed person
- ✓ One MWhatsApp Port Coordinator from your centre
- ✓ About 45–60 minutes to complete the initial port questionnaire
- ✓ Telegram on the coordinator's phone, for ongoing updates afterwards
- ✓ A 30-minute introductory call, online
- ✓ Willingness to collaborate — fully voluntary participation

### How Partnership Starts

- 1 Get in touch**  
We reply within 24 hours.
- 2 Introductory call**  
30–45 min online, within two weeks.
- 3 Centre profile & questionnaire**  
Your centre is added to the international registry, and your coordinator completes the structured port questionnaire.
- 4 Pilot begins**  
IMWIRSA reviews the questionnaire, platform access is granted, and your port goes live.

Ready to start the conversation?

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